

Week 8: Marriage II

JSS1 Christian Religious Studies (CRS) — First Term Lesson Note (Deep-Dive Edition)

Introduction

Continuing from last topic, this week looks at the different types of marriage recognized in society, and why marriage remains important both biblically and socially.

Types of Marriage

Type	Description
Monogamy	A marriage between one man and one woman
Polygamy	A marriage where a man has more than one wife (practised in some traditional African settings, though not the biblical ideal)
Christian/Church marriage	A marriage conducted in a church, following Christian rites and vows
Traditional marriage	A marriage conducted according to the customs and rites of a particular ethnic group or community
Court/Civil marriage	A marriage conducted and registered under civil law, usually at a marriage registry

Importance of Marriage

- Provides companionship and emotional support between husband and wife
- Provides a stable environment for procreation and raising children
- Builds and strengthens family and community bonds
- Provides economic partnership and shared responsibility
- Fulfils God's original design and purpose for human relationships
- Promotes social stability and order within the community

Real-Life Application

Understanding the different types of marriage helps students appreciate the variety of marriage customs practised in Nigeria and elsewhere, while also understanding the core biblical principles — love, companionship, and commitment — that remain central to any marriage, regardless of type.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
Monogamy	Marriage to only one spouse at a time
Polygamy	Marriage involving more than one spouse at the same time
Registry	An official office where civil marriages are recorded and legalized

Evaluation Questions

- 1 List four types of marriage.
- 2 Explain the difference between monogamy and polygamy.
- 3 What is a “traditional marriage”?
- 4 Where does a couple go to have a civil/court marriage?
- 5 Give two reasons why marriage is important to society.
- 6 How does marriage promote social stability?
- 7 Explain why marriage is considered an economic partnership.
- 8 In your own words, describe a Christian/church marriage.
- 9 Why might different communities have different marriage customs?
- 10 Which type of marriage do you think best reflects the biblical account in Genesis 2:24? Explain your answer.